

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

Looking for Belonging Without Knowing Where Home Is

The lost do not always know they are lost, because they do not know there is somewhere they belong.



BIG IDEA

A person can feel completely at home and still live apart from the God for whom human life was made.

KEY SCRIPTURE

Ephesians 2:12-13, 19 Far off -> Made nigh Strangers -> God's household

MEMORY VERSE

Luke 19:10 "For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost."

? WHAT DOES LOST MEAN?

FAR OFF

Living apart from God while looking elsewhere for life, identity, and belonging.

JESUS SEEKS AND SAVES

BROUGHT NIGH

Fellowcitizens and members of the household of God in Christ.

SHEEP

wanders

COIN

valuable but out of place

YOUNGER SON

chooses the far country

OLDER SON

near the house, far from the father

LOST DOES NOT MEAN WORTHLESS. THE LOST ARE KNOWN, VALUED, AND SOUGHT.

FOUR TRUTHS TO REMEMBER

1

LOST IS NOT UNUSUALLY EVIL

A moral, kind, religious person may still live apart from God.

2

LOSTNESS MAY FEEL NORMAL

Feeling comfortable does not prove we are where we belong.

3

RELIGIOUS NEARNESS IS NOT UNION

The older son was near the house without knowing the father.

4

CHRIST BRINGS THE LOST HOME

He seeks, saves, brings near, and makes strangers family.

? THINK ABOUT IT

1

Where do I most often look for belonging?

2

Can that good thing tell me who I am and what my life is for?

3

Am I near Christian things, or do I actually belong to Christ?

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THIS WEEK

Notice every place you seek the answer to "Where do I belong?" Write down one observation and bring it next week.

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YOU MAY TALK WITH US

If you wonder whether you belong to Christ, you do not have to answer publicly or pretend certainty. A leader will listen and open the Bible with you privately.

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BECAUSE THEY DO NOT KNOW THERE IS SOMEWHERE THEY BELONG.